

Metis Cortex.

Drafts your file note during the conference — then helps the client actually return the documents you ask for.

A WORKING TOOL FOR NSW FAMILY-LAW PRACTICES

It's 9pm.

You're writing up this morning's conference from memory and a page of half-legible notes — the separation date, who's been paying the mortgage, the thing she said about the kids' school that might matter for relocation. You'll have it mostly right. But "mostly right" at 9pm is the job nobody bills for. **Metis Cortex does that write-up while the conference is still happening.**

What it is

Software that sits alongside the client conference and turns the consult itself into the file work. With all-party consent it records and transcribes the meeting, and by the time the client leaves you have a **draft file note, case brief and client proposal** — each one yours to review, edit and sign off. You stay the practitioner; it's assistance, not advice, and it never pretends otherwise. It runs **on top of LEAP or Smokeball** — no migration, no rebuild of your file.

What it actually does, live

- **Flags the legal issues as they come up**, against *current* AU family law — the post-2024 parenting amendments and the property reforms commencing June 2025, not last decade's.
- **Runs a live AustLII case-law search mid-conference**, so a relevant authority surfaces while it's useful — not three days later in an email.
- **Walks the NSW *Surveillance Devices Act* consent step before recording** — built in, not bolted on.

Where this comes from

I'm not a lawyer. I've been the client in Australian family law three times — including a current self-represented FCFCOA matter — and I ran one business for 21 years. This is the tool I kept wishing existed from the other side of the desk. You know me; you know that's true.

What's coming — and where I want your steer

The solicitor side above is built. The **client side is being built**: after the first meeting, when you've told the client what to bring, Metis walks them through actually getting it — from myGov, the ATO, their bank, the court file — and back to you. So the gap between "go and get these documents" and them landing on your desk doesn't stretch into weeks of chasing. It's early: a handful of founding firms, no customers yet. I'd rather build it with you than show you a finished thing you'd have designed differently.

Two asks

1. **Your read**: would the client side — clients actually returning the documents you ask for after the first meeting — genuinely cut your chasing, or am I solving a problem you don't have?
2. **A paid review of the compliance side**: the s178 costs-disclosure exposure, where the unqualified-practice line sits, and whether the file-note structure holds up against NSW professional standards.

Metis Cortex is a document and drafting assistant. Every output is a draft the solicitor reviews, edits and owns. It is not a law firm and does not provide legal advice. Early stage — founding firms only.

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